RAJAT RAO

Researcher and Geospatial Analyst



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ABOUT ME

A curious and committed individual with a deep interest in the natural world and a strong focus on climate change and its impact on ecosystems. With a background in wildlife conservation, geoinformatics and engineering, I enjoy exploring how technology and spatial thinking can help us respond to environmental change and influence policy.

EDUCATION

P.G. DIPLOMA IN GEOINFORMATICS
Institute of Good Manufacturing Practices India, Delhi — 9.86 CGPA

M. SC. IN WILDLIFE CONSERVATION ACTION
Bharati Vidhyapeeth Deemed University, Pune — 8.93 CGPA

B. E. IN ELECTRONICS & COMMUNICATION
Dr. Ambedkar Institute of Technology, Bengaluru — 8.58 CGPA

LANGUAGES

- English
- Kannada
- Marathi
- Hindi

SOFTWARE

MS Office, Python, R, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, LabVIEW, ArcGIS, TerrSet

WORK EXPERIENCE

Nature Conservation Foundation - Research Assistant **2023-2025**

Geospatial Analyst and Data Manager with the High Altitude Program, responsible for managing spatial datasets, supporting cartographic needs, and integrating technology into conservation workflows.

Nature Conservation Foundation - Project Intern **2023-2023**

Processed camera trap-based distance sampling data for blue sheep in the High Himalayas and assisted the field team with data collection and various field activities.

Eco-Volunteers India - Research Coordinator **2021-2022**

Supported the Forest Department with snare removal, crowd management during festivals, and forest fire-fighting. Assisted in installing solar bore-wells to restore wildlife water sources, conducted community awareness programs.

Nature Conservation Foundation - Research Intern **2020-2021**

Worked as part of the Holématthi team, contributing to study on leopard ecology. Responsibilities included setting up and monitoring camera traps in the field, collecting and organizing data from the traps, assisting with data sorting and analysis, and organizing community events to support the sale of locally made products from forest fringe villages.

Sasken Tech. Ltd. - Automation Engineer **2016-2018**

Designed and developed automation test suites for international clients, leveraging Python and LabVIEW to build robust continuous integration systems tailored to diverse project requirements.

PUBLICATIONS

Camera traps placed to detect predators underestimate prey densities. Oryx – The International Journal of Conservation. Cambridge University Press.
https://doi.org/10.1017/S0030605325101543

Finding the ghosts: Snow leopard density and distribution in the multi-use region of Jammu and Kashmir, India. British Ecological Society Journal.
https://doi.org/10.1002/2688-8319.70155

LICENSES AND ACCOMPLISHMENTS

GATE 2026 - GEOMATICS - AIR 173
AMATEUR WIRELSS STATION LICENSE
TERRA.DO CLIMATE ACTION FELLOW 2022
BASIC MOUNTAINEERING COURSE (GRADE A)
ISO 14001: 2015 EMS AND ISO 45001: 2018 OHSMS
SHORT-FILM ON MASTER'S THESIS SCREENED AT CMS VATAVARAN